Definition of Antisemitism." Additionally, the definition was to serve as "a practical guide for identifying incidents, collecting data, and supporting the implementation and enforcement of legislation dealing with antisemitism."[20]

Most crucially perhaps, the *informally adopted* working definition acknowledged that manifestations of antisemitism "could also target the state of Israel, conceived as a Jewish collectivity." It explained, "Antisemitism frequently charges Jews with conspiring to harm humanity, and it is often used to blame Jews for 'why things go wrong.'"[21] In providing examples for clarification, the Centre focused first on the expression of this prejudice in public life more generally and then on the antisemitic idiom specifically targeting Israel.

The definition recognized that when criticism of Israel is similar to that leveled against any other country, such criticism cannot be regarded as antisemitic. However, it was equally clear about other behaviors that "could" be. Among these, it noted that "holding Jews collectively responsible for actions in the state of Israel" and "drawing comparisons of contemporary Israeli policy to that of the Nazis" is antisemitic. The working definition also identified as problematic the application of "double standards" for Israel (standards not expected of any other democratic state). Not least, it condemned "denying the Jewish people their right to self-determination (e.g., by claiming that the existence of a state of Israel is a racist endeavor)."[22]

With the "new" antisemitism targeting Israel as the "collective Jew" among nations, Israel's delegitimation proved impossible to ignore. As Robert Wistrich explains, antisemitism is "no longer expressed primarily in the form of a direct assault upon the rights of Jews to live as equal members of the non-Jewish societies which they inhabit." Instead, "the 'new' antisemitism involves the denial of the rights of the Jewish people to live as an equal member within the family of nations."[23] Put differently, "If anti-Semites once aspired to live in a world rid of Jews, today anti-Semitism's goal is apparently a world cleansed of the Jewish state."[24]

Expecting that the Centre's working definition might oblige Member States to combat this "new" antisemitism, Jewish organizations and various state actors (perhaps especially those based outside of Europe) hailed its 2005 adoption. For instance, when the U.S. Congress passed the Global Anti-Semitism Review Act of 2004, in response to rising antisemitism worldwide, it mandated a one-time investigation into antisemitic acts. The authors of that report then adopted the EUMC's working definition for their research.[25] When Canadian Members of Parliament passed a resolution to combat antisemitism in 2007 and later reaffirmed it through the Ottawa Protocol in 2012, they too cited the EU's seemingly authoritative definition, as did the

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